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BCAENLS 201

II Semester B.C.A. Examination, June/July 2026

(SEP) 2024 – 25 Batch Onwards)

ENGLISH LANGUAGE

Time : 3 Hours

Max. Marks : 80

SECTION – A

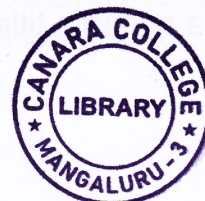
(Prose)

- I. A) Answer **any one** of the following in about **200** words. **(1×10=10)**
- 1) What message does Mihir Sen convey to the youth of India through his daring adventure and how is it relevant today ?
 - 2) How do the characters in “Action Will be Taken” respond to the overwhelming demand to put on an appearance of being active ?
 - 3) Compare and contrast Nagelipennu and Bhanumati in the story “Wooden Cradles”.
 - 4) Is the Long Nosed One to be pitied or laughed at ? Give reasons for your answer.
- B) Answer **any two** of the following in about **100** words **each**. **(2×5=10)**
- 1) How do Shia families celebrate a baby crossing the threshold in “Styles of Welcoming Life” ?
 - 2) What is the protagonist’s reaction to criticism about his nose in “The World Renowned Nose” ?
 - 3) Do you think Nagelipennu could have changed her life in “Wooden Cradles” ? Did she have any options ?
 - 4) Describe in brief how the narrator was appointed to work in Alfred Wunsiedel’s factory in the story “Action Will be Taken”.
 - 5) How did the environmental conditions affect Mihir Sen during his swim ?

SECTION – B

(Poetry)

- II. A) Answer **any one** of the following in about **200** words. **(1×10=10)**
- 1) Analyse how Owen uses the concept of ‘friend’ and ‘enemy’ in the poem “Strange Meeting”.
 - 2) How does the poet describe the world of the blind child in the poem “A Blind Child” ?





- 3) Attempt a character sketch of the mother as portrayed in the poem "Ecology".
- 4) How does the poem "Animals" serve as a critique of modern society and its values ?

B) Answer **any two** of the following in about **100** words **each**. **(2×5=10)**

- 1) How is the difference between the sighted speaker in the poem and the blind child established in "A Blind Child" ?
- 2) How does the poet encourage readers to live in the present moment in the poem "A Psalm of Life" ?
- 3) Why did the poet's mother not allow the Champak trees to be cut in "Ecology" ?
- 4) What is the significance of the phrase 'they are so placid and self-contain'd' in the poem "Animals" ? Substantiate.
- 5) How does "Strange Meeting" reflect on the futility of war ?

SECTION – C
(Grammar and Composition)
Unit – I

III. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow.

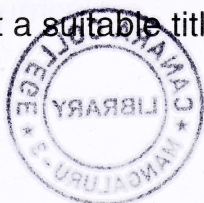
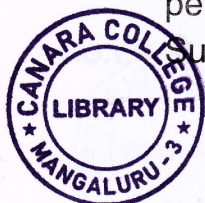
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People do not always do the things we want them to do. No matter how reasonable or minimal our expectations may be, there are times when we are let down. Naturally, we feel upset and hurt when our expectations are not met. We dread confrontations because they are unpleasant and can damage relationships. Yet, not confronting does not solve the problem because unresolved issues also affect relationships in an adverse way. Actually, the real problem lies in our style of confrontation, not in the issue. Typically, we use character-based confrontations. They help in venting our anger and hurt, but that is the only thing they do. They lead to angry show-downs and bring all discussions to a grinding halt.

It is important to remember that self-image is the most important possession of all human beings. It is the way we view and regard ourselves in our own eyes and in the eyes of others. As self-conscious beings, we are acutely aware of our image and constantly work towards protecting it from any damage. We also seek approval from others about our own self-image. We feel distraught if we sense that there is even a slight threat to our self-image, because our character is the essence of our lives.

To ensure a rational dialogue over dashed expectations, we need to deploy issue based confrontations. They involve an explanation of which actions have bothered us, in what manner and what changes we would like from the other person.

Suggest a suitable title for the passage.





IV. Do as directed.

- 1) Choose the right **synonym** from the passage (given in question number III) for the underlined word in the sentences given below : (2×1=2)

- i) The bus came to a Stop.
- ii) The bill is awaiting the Governor's assent.

- 2) Fill in the blanks with appropriate **antonym** of the word underlined in the sentences given below : (2×1=2)

- i) The task seems simple, but it is actually _____.
- ii) He always speaks the truth and never tells a _____.

- 3) Fill in the blank with the correct homophone from the options given in brackets : 1

- i) We decided to _____ a ship that was headed to deep waters. (board/bored)

- ii) Fill in the blanks in the following sentences with a single **homonym**. 1

- a) Flowers bloom during the _____ season.
- b) The mattress has a broken _____.

- 4) Fill in the blanks by modifying the words given in brackets by adding a suitable **prefix** or **suffix** : (2×1=2)

- i) The package remained _____ (opened) on the table.
- ii) Her _____ (kind) was appreciated by everyone.

- 5) i) Match the word in Column – A with the right collocation given in Column – B : 1

Column – A

Deep

Column – B

i) surprise

ii) mistake

iii) trouble

- ii) Fill in the blank with the right alternative given in brackets : 1

She gave me a nice _____. (compliment/complement)

Unit – II

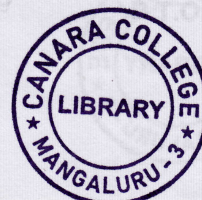
V. Do as directed :

- 1) Rewrite **any three** of the following sentences in reported speech : (3×1=3)

- a) "I will bring a cake to the party," said Kate.
- b) Nelson said, "I am feeling sick today."
- c) The teacher said, "Stand up."
- d) Jane said, "Have you read this book ?"

- 2) Write a dialogue in **ten to twelve** sentences choosing **any one** of the situations given below : (1×5=5)

- a) Two people are trapped in an elevator and are discussing how to get help.
- b) A passenger talking to a ticket collector about a lost ticket.





- 3) Read the following passage and write a summary that is **one-third** of the original passage. **(1×5=5)**

Ensure that the main points of the passage are covered in the summary.

Understanding the true nature of memory requires looking beyond the idea of a simple “filing cabinet.” First, memory is not a perfect video recording of our lives. While we often believe our recollections are objective truths, they are actually reconstructive processes. Every time we recall an event, our brain essentially reassembles it from fragments, often adding new information or subtle biases based on our current feelings. Even animals possess memory systems—migratory birds remember vast geographic routes and squirrels remember thousands of nut locations—but their memories are primarily functional and tied to survival. Human memory, however, allows for “mental time travel”, enabling us to reflect on our identity and learn from complex social experiences. Second, memory is not limited to what we study in textbooks or intentionally memorize for exams. It is a fundamental, constant background process of the human mind. We possess “procedural” memories that allow us to ride a bike without thinking, and “implicit” memories that influence our likes and dislikes without us knowing why. Every experience we have leaves a trace, whether we are aware of it or not. Interestingly, the brain often prioritizes emotional experiences over mundane ones, meaning we remember the “feeling” of an event long after the specific details have faded. Conversely, we might forget important facts while vividly remembering a trivial comment from childhood. Memory is not a static storage unit; it is a living, breathing part of who we are (239 words).

- 4) Write a speech in about **100** words on **any one** of the topics/situations given below. **(1×5=5)**

- Your college is celebrating Gandhi Jayanthi. Prepare a welcome speech for the event.
- Your college is hosting a seminar on “Career opportunities in Digital Marketing.” Prepare a speech to introduce the guest speaker to the audience.
- Draft a speech on the impact of social media on youth.

- 5) Write an essay in about **200** words on **any one** of the topics/situations given below. Use the hints given below the topic to develop the essay. **(1×10=10)**

- a) Environmental Conservation : The need of the hour.

Increasing pollution and global warming — depletion of natural resources — importance of the reduce, reuse, recycle mantra — role of individuals vs governments — planting trees — preserving the planet for future generations.

- b) The role of sports in Personality Development.

More than just physical fitness — teaching teamwork and discipline — handling victory and defeat — importance of time management — impact on mental health and stress relief — necessity in the school curriculum.

